

# 21 MAGIC MOVEMENT TIPS FOR A HEALTHIER AND LEANER BODY

*by Performance Treanor*



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## Tip 1

### Start small

Start small when beginning to exercise more and also when recommencing after some time away from it.

## Tip 2

### Slow and steady wins the race

A killer amount of exercise every session can result in injury, fatigue and maybe even contribute to burnout.

Reasonably tough and consistent training is much better. The killer session should be the exception and not the rule. 🤖

## Tip 3

### Make it a habit with the 3 r's

Reminder (note on phone at 11.00 says get up from desk), routine (5-minute energising stretch) and reward (more energy and looser body) makes habits stick.

Then movement goes from effort to habit without too much compromise and becomes just as habitual as brushing your teeth.

## **Tip 4**

### **Know why you're doing it**

Am I training predominantly for body composition, health or performance or a mix of all three?

Knowing where your focus lies should be reflected in how you train and eat.

## **Tip 5**

### **GET ACCOUNTABLE**

Having a gym buddy or personal trainer helps to get you out the door/to the zoom session. 😊

It also helps get movement commitments in the calendar and build teamwork around your fitness goals.

You are more likely to quit when it's only yourself involved.

## Tip 6

### Micro doses are good (of movement not mushrooms 🤪)

Small doses of movement throughout the day can add up to have a big positive impact on your body. 🙌

It can also make movement more manageable when dealing with a particularly busy day where you don't want to block out a whole 30-60 minutes to workout.

Here's an example of an easy and fun micro dose movement game.

## Tip 7

### Technique trumps weight

Don't think about heavy weight until that technique is good.

If you run before you walk in the weights room it will cause injury.

## Tip 8

### Whatever it takes to get started

Maybe one day it is listening to a banging playlist that helps you get out for that run.

Or another day it might be yoga stretches in front of Netflix.

How can you make it more pleasant for yourself to get started?



## Tip 9

### Movement Facilitators

When we place things in our environment that remind us to move and exercise then we are more likely to do it.

How about running shoes beside the door or a yoga mat beside the TV?

Whatever it is to build the healthy movement habit, it is easier when we make our everyday environment facilitate and encourage the routine.

## Tip 10

### Technology can help and hinders movement – choose wisely 😊

Have been caught in the trap myself of being annoyed when technology failed me on a run and I got annoyed...

If the only reason you're out running is for the kudos on strava then something is wrong. Remember the joy of running as a kid when nothing else mattered but the movement itself. Never lose that.

On the other hand I do believe performance tracking is helpful for commitment to fitness goals as long as we don't overly compare to others but rather emulate the positives we can learn from them. 🙌

## Tip 11

### Exercise can up resilience

Getting through a tough workout can help us realise we can overcome stress and adversity and come out feeling great on the other side.

The feeling of confidence and self-efficacy that comes from this can follow us into other elements of our lives.

## Tip 12

### The core is not only your abs

It's made up of your obliques, pelvic floor and lower back too - don't neglect them. 🙌 Here's a 5-minute quick hitter targeting each of the core four. 😊

## Tip 13

### Fat loss is not localised

Therefore 30 minutes of crunches is not the answer to belly fat. For better fat loss results, work your whole body over the full week of training and match it with nutrition efforts.

## Tip 14

### Tempo matters

I've done this wrong as a gym goer and seen tempo on exercises so wrong many times working as a coach in a gym.

First of all, going too fast can cause sloppy movement. Not only this but you don't benefit as much from an important concept called time under tension when you rush.

Slow and steady wins the race 🏆

## Tip 15

### Movement brings us together

Whether it's salsa dancing with your partner or running with a mate, it's all good exercise and sociable - double whammy I hear you say 🏆

Involving others in our fitness goals can really help us keep on track.

Experiences are best shared 🏆

## Tip 16

### It's chemical

Exercise and not for long... A large amount of the benefits that come from exercise come after just 20 minutes of physical activity.

Exercise is also associated with the production of neurotransmitters -- including serotonin, dopamine and endorphins – that are the very same neurotransmitters we don't get enough of when we're feeling anxious.

## Tip 17

### It's amazingly adaptable

Physical activity can be adapted to suit our mood. If you are really low on motivation or energy then a leisurely walk might be the solution that day.

There will be other days the body is telling us to kick on and that can be fun to do 💪💪

Sometimes on a low mood day I have actually been surprised at myself for powering out a great workout once I had the first few minutes behind me...

The skill is in realising what day calls for what kind of workout or having a well thought out programme which eliminates guess work and allows for plenty of recovery.

## Tip 18

### Movement is fun and free entertainment

In a world where there are so many entertainment options that cost big dollars, we sometimes forget the fantastically frugal and free forms of entertainment.

Covid 19 meant that to meet with friends many of us began to walk and talk more whereas before it might have been a trip to the pub or café to meet up.

I hope people keep the healthy and free movement habits going when life gets back to the new normal.

## Tip 19

### Make it fun

Everyone has a different opinion of what this is. For some it is more about fun with the people you workout move or dance with as opposed to the specific form of exercise.

But here's the important thing and it's hardly a news flash - if you don't enjoy it to some degree it will not become a habit or routine.

## Tip 20

### A little effort goes a long way

Sedentarism is the new smoking and is defined as 5,000 steps or less per day.

If you up it from there to 75 minutes brisk walking it could add 2-years to your life. Not bad eh?

People don't realise the little efforts like getting a walk in or taking the stairs instead of elevators can add time, energy and happiness to their lives.

## Tip 21

### Movement is infectious and addictive

This is great news cause when you discover something you enjoy it can quickly turn from effort to routine.

Keep at it and if you need some help along the way - let me know ❤️

# Good luck



## Get in touch with me

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# About me

## Hi, my name is Declan Treanor.

I believe that we all want to do our best. It is rare that anyone gets out of bed in the morning and thinks, "I want to do something negative today, annoy people and get given out to for doing a bad job". People want to perform to the best of their ability in all facets of their lives.

This might sound stressful, always needing to perform but it is not. The idea is this, simply put: even when you are relaxing and recharging your batteries, you want to do it optimally so you feel great and re-energised afterwards.

How can we get there? How can we live to the best of our ability? The key is to live a balanced life in mind, body and soul - my holy trinity - which I train myself and help people train every day.

Working as a business consultant I realised that the "always on" work mode was not for me. I needed balance between fulfilling work, looking after my body (exercise, sleep and nutrition) and a greater good (sports clubs, charity work, fun projects with friends, etc.).

I have always lived my life based on instinct for what felt right at the time and that has meant tough decisions. Leaving what many would consider a perfect job to set up my own company which may or may not have succeeded.

Over the years, I also came to experience myself and to notice that while a lot of athletes thrive in demonstrating their athletic capabilities, they sometimes have a struggle emotionally and mentally. This clearly has an impact on their performance and enjoyment. It got me interested in the whole spectrum of health and wellness and I developed a passion for organisational behaviour, sports psychology, personal training, nutrition and mindfulness - please note I have completed qualifications and certifications in all of these areas. You see, I am always fascinated by how human beings can get the best out of themselves and how we can facilitate the environment for them to do so.

I really hate hearing of somebody who let fear hold them back from achieving a big goal or pursuing a passion and my life's purpose is to ensure this happens to as few people as possible.

And with this purpose, the Performance Treanor journey really began.



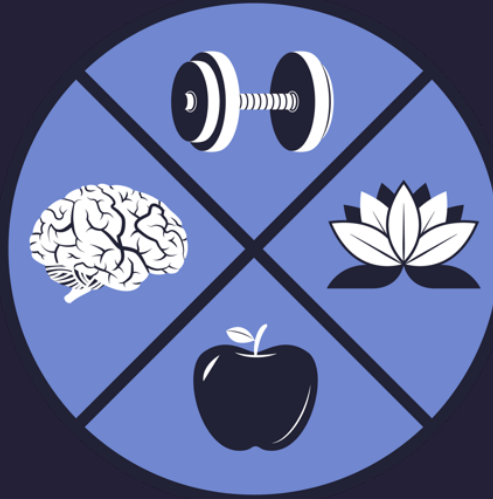
In 2016, I started interviewing high performers in sports, academia, music and business to understand better what impacted their performance, where that came from and how to deal with it to perform at best. I then founded Performance Treanor to share their learnings with anyone interested in what they had to say through featured articles and podcasts on a blog.

Since then, I qualified as an iCREPS accredited Personal Trainer and a MNU ce Certified Nutritionist. I also hold a Continued Professional Development certification in Mindfulness.

I am now on a mission to help people live more confidently and happier in themselves now and moving forward, focusing on:

- **Mind** (positive self-talk, dealing with distorted thoughts, mindfulness and managing the chimp brain).
- **Body** (sleep, movement, nutrition and hydration to nourish the body and give you the best chance to feel energised, happy and look fresh).
- **Soul** (having the confidence to set meaningful stretch goals and stick to them with laser like focus. Knowing what we value in life, remembering to reach out, love wholeheartedly and communicate vulnerably to let ourselves be truly seen).

I helped hundreds of people on their journey to living a happier, healthier and more meaningful life with weight loss, exercise and nutrition programmes, wellness workshops, an online course to achieve better energy, productivity and self-confidence, and have many tips on all of these areas on my blog. See you there!



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